



1 second
before
zero time



time of the
action (zero
time)



-750ms



-500ms

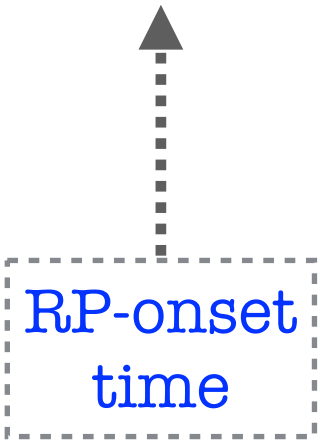


-250ms





W time
(time of
conscious
willing)



It appears that the subject's brain is ready to flex the hand about 350ms **before**

the subject's experience of consciously deciding to flex his or her hand.

This makes it seem as though the conscious “decision” to flex one’s hand is not really a decision at all — that decision has already been made, unconsciously, by the brain.



replies to
Libet

A solid red circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the Libet experiments" is written in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font, centered horizontally and vertically.

the Libet
experiments



is free will
an important
good?

It appears that the subject's brain is ready to flex the hand about 350ms before

the subject's experience of consciously deciding to flex his or her hand.

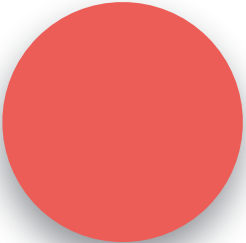
'decision' to flex one's hand is not really a decision

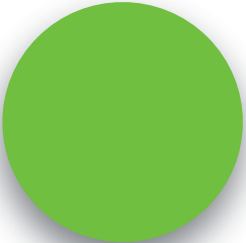
This makes it seem as though the conscious

unconsciously, by the brain.

at all $\rightarrow$ that decision has already been made,







In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After

the birth of modern physics, many worried about the challenges it would bring from

determinism. Our topic today is much more recent challenge to free

will prosper by contemporary neuroscience.

A large, solid red circle serves as the background for the text.

the Libet experiments

the brain.

This makes it seem as though the conscious 'decision' to flex one's hand is not

really a decision at all — that decision has already been made, unconsciously, by

the subject's experience of consciously deciding to flex his or her hand.

It appears that the subject's brain is ready to flex the hand about 350ms before